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DEFENSE COMMISSARY AGENCY (DeCA)

Supply Chain Operations Division / Logistics & Distribution Directorate

STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

SOP-03: Order Fulfillment

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1. Purpose

The purpose of this Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) is to establish and standardize the end-to-end order fulfillment process for all outbound shipments originating from Defense Commissary Agency (DeCA) distribution centers (DCs). This SOP governs the receipt of customer orders through the DeCA Order Management System (OMS), the execution of warehouse picking, packing, staging, and loading operations, and the final handoff of shipments to authorized transportation carriers.

This document is intended to ensure that DeCA's distribution operations consistently achieve a minimum order accuracy rate of **≥99%** and an on-time delivery performance rate of **≥98%** for all outbound shipments destined for military commissaries, installation stores, and other authorized DeCA customers worldwide. By defining clear, repeatable procedures for every stage of the fulfillment cycle, this SOP minimizes the risk of mis-picks, short shipments, damaged goods, and delivery failures that could negatively impact military family readiness and commissary operational continuity.

This SOP further supports DeCA's strategic mission to provide quality grocery products and household goods to authorized patrons — including active-duty service members, retirees, reservists, and their dependents — at significant savings compared to commercial retail outlets. Consistent, accurate, and timely order fulfillment is foundational to that mission.

POLICY STATEMENT

All personnel assigned to distribution center fulfillment operations are required to adhere to the procedures set forth in this SOP. Deviations must be documented, reported to the Order Fulfillment Coordinator, and reviewed by the Supply Chain Operations Division. Unauthorized deviations may result in

corrective action in accordance with applicable DeCA personnel policies.

2. Scope

This SOP applies to all personnel engaged in distribution center (DC) order fulfillment operations within the Defense Commissary Agency supply chain network. The scope of applicability is defined as follows:

- **DC Order Picking Staff:** All warehouse associates responsible for picking product from storage locations in accordance with system-generated pick lists and wave assignments.
- **DC Packing Staff:** All warehouse associates assigned to pack stations (PS-1, PS-2, PS-3) responsible for verifying, packaging, labeling, and sealing outbound cartons.
- **Staging and Dock Personnel:** All associates responsible for building pallets, staging shipments, and loading trailers at DeCA DC dock doors.
- **Warehouse Management System (WMS) Administrators:** Personnel responsible for maintaining, configuring, and operating the DeCA WMS, including wave planning, pick task generation, inventory adjustments, and system reconciliation.
- **Transportation Coordinators:** Personnel responsible for carrier booking, manifest generation, Bill of Lading (BOL) issuance, and coordination with authorized transportation carriers through the DeCA Transportation Management System (TMS).
- **Order Fulfillment Coordinators:** Supervisory personnel responsible for overseeing daily fulfillment operations, managing priority escalations, and coordinating cross-functional activities between picking, packing, staging, and transportation teams.

This SOP applies to all product categories handled within DeCA DC operations, including ambient, refrigerated, and frozen goods, as well as general merchandise. It applies to all order types processed through the DeCA OMS, including Priority, Standard, and Bulk Scheduled orders (see Section 6).

This SOP does **not** apply to inbound receiving operations (governed by SOP-01), vendor compliance procedures (governed by SOP-02), or returns/reverse logistics (governed by SOP-08). Transportation carrier performance standards are further detailed in SOP-04.

3. References

The following documents, directives, and regulations are referenced by or provide governing authority for the procedures contained in this SOP. Personnel should consult these references for matters not explicitly addressed herein.

Document / Reference	Description / Applicability
DeCA Directive 40-13	DeCA Directive governing Supply Chain and Distribution Operations. Establishes baseline requirements for inventory management, order processing, and fulfillment accuracy across all DeCA distribution centers. This SOP is subordinate to and compliant with DeCA Directive 40-13.
DoD Instruction 4140.01	DoD Supply Chain Materiel Management Policy. Provides overarching DoD policy for materiel management, including storage, distribution, and transportation. All DeCA fulfillment operations must comply with applicable provisions of DoDI 4140.01.
DeCA Transportation Management Plan, Rev. 2026	Governs carrier selection, routing, rate agreements, and transportation performance standards for all outbound shipments from DeCA distribution centers. Transportation Coordinators must reference this plan when

Document / Reference	Description / Applicability
	executing carrier bookings under Section 11 of this SOP.
Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) Part 47	Establishes federal regulatory requirements for transportation contracting, including carrier liability, shipment documentation, and transportation terms and conditions applicable to government freight movements.
DeCA Vendor Compliance Manual (Current Edition)	Defines packaging, labeling, barcode, and shipment readiness requirements that vendors must meet. Relevant to packing and labeling steps in Section 9 of this SOP when DeCA-sourced materials are used for repackaging or consolidation.
DeCA SOP-04	Transportation Carrier Management SOP. Governs carrier selection criteria, rate table application, and carrier performance monitoring. Referenced in Section 11 of this SOP for carrier booking procedures.
DeCA SOP-07	Cold Chain and Temperature-Sensitive Product Handling SOP. Governs the packing materials, temperature monitoring, and maximum ambient exposure limits for refrigerated and frozen products. Referenced in Section 9.4 of this SOP.

4. Definitions

For the purposes of this SOP, the following terms and definitions apply. All personnel must be familiar with these definitions prior to executing any fulfillment activity.

Term	Definition
Pick List	A system-generated document or electronic task (delivered via RF

Term	Definition
	scanner) that instructs a picker on which products to retrieve, from which storage locations, and in what quantities to fulfill one or more customer orders. Pick lists are generated by the WMS upon wave release.
Wave Pick	A picking strategy in which the WMS groups multiple orders into a "wave" and releases all associated pick tasks simultaneously to available pickers. Wave picking maximizes picking efficiency by clustering orders with common attributes such as carrier, ship date, or destination zone.
Zone Pick	A picking method in which the DC warehouse is divided into designated product zones (e.g., dry grocery, frozen, produce, general merchandise). Each picker is assigned to work exclusively within one zone, completing picks for all orders requiring product from that zone before passing the order downstream.
Batch Pick	A picking strategy in which a single picker retrieves items for multiple orders simultaneously in a single pass through the warehouse. Batch picking reduces travel time and increases picker productivity. Picked items are sorted to individual orders at the pack station.
Pack Station	A designated workstation within the DC where picked items are verified against order details, packaged into cartons, dimensionally weighed, labeled with carrier shipping labels, and prepared for staging. Active pack stations at DeCA DCs include PS-1, PS-2, and PS-3.
Manifest	A detailed, system-generated document that lists all shipments, cartons, weights, dimensions, and order identifiers assigned to a specific carrier trailer or transportation movement. The manifest is transmitted electronically to the carrier via the DeCA TMS upon load completion.
Bill of Lading (BOL)	A legally binding document issued by

Term	Definition
	the shipper (DeCA DC) to the carrier that serves as a contract of carriage, a receipt for goods, and a document of title. The BOL identifies the shipper, consignee, carrier, commodity description, total weight, and number of pieces. The BOL must be signed by the carrier driver upon load acceptance.
Carrier Booking	The process of reserving capacity with an authorized transportation carrier for a scheduled pickup at the DeCA DC. Carrier bookings are executed through the DeCA Transportation Management System (TMS) in accordance with the rate table defined in SOP-04.
Order Accuracy Rate	A key performance indicator (KPI) calculated as the percentage of outbound orders shipped with the correct items, quantities, and destinations relative to the total number of orders shipped in a given period. Formula: $(\text{Orders Shipped Without Error} \div \text{Total Orders Shipped}) \times 100$. Target: $\geq 99.5\%$.
On-Time Shipment Rate	A KPI measuring the percentage of orders tendered to the carrier on or before the scheduled ship date and time. Formula: $(\text{On-Time Shipments} \div \text{Total Shipments}) \times 100$. Target: $\geq 98\%$.
Priority Order	An order designated by the OMS or by authorized DeCA personnel as requiring expedited fulfillment due to military readiness requirements, emergency resupply needs, or other mission-critical circumstances. Priority orders require same-day picking and next-day shipment. See Section 6.
FIFO (First In, First Out)	An inventory rotation principle requiring that product received earliest (oldest lot/date code) is picked and shipped first, ahead of newer inventory. FIFO is enforced by the WMS at all pick locations and is mandatory for all product categories to minimize expired-product risk and support food safety compliance.

5. Roles and Responsibilities

The following table defines the key personnel roles involved in the order fulfillment process and their associated responsibilities. Each role is accountable for performing its assigned functions in compliance with this SOP and applicable DeCA policies.

Role / Position	Responsibilities
Order Fulfillment Coordinator	Serves as the primary operational supervisor for all DC order fulfillment activities. Responsibilities include: overseeing daily wave planning and pick execution; managing priority order escalations; resolving short-pick and inventory discrepancy issues; coordinating with WMS Administrators and Transportation Coordinators on scheduling; monitoring real-time fulfillment KPIs; and reporting operational issues to DC management. The Order Fulfillment Coordinator has authority to reassign pickers (e.g., PKR-07, PKR-12, PKR-15) and re-sequence waves to meet carrier cutoff times.
Picker (e.g., PKR-07, PKR-12, PKR-15)	Responsible for executing directed pick tasks as assigned by the WMS via RF scanner. Pickers must: navigate to directed pick locations; scan location barcodes and product UPC/barcodes to confirm accurate picks; enforce FIFO rotation by selecting earliest lot/date code first; accurately record short picks with appropriate reason codes; place picked items on designated pallets or carts by order/wave assignment; and deliver picked goods to the appropriate pack station (PS-1, PS-2, or PS-3) upon task completion.
Packer	Assigned to a designated pack station (PS-1, PS-2, or PS-3). Responsible for: receiving picked items from pickers;

Role / Position	Responsibilities
	scanning each item to verify against the order record in the WMS; applying dimensional weight calculations to carton selection; packing items according to product type (ambient, refrigerated, or frozen); inserting packing slips into each carton; sealing cartons; applying carrier shipping labels with required data elements; and placing sealed cartons on staging pallets. Packers must flag any discrepancies between received picks and order records to the Order Fulfillment Coordinator immediately.
Dock Supervisor	Manages all dock door operations and trailer loading activities. Responsibilities include: assigning trailers to dock doors per carrier schedule; supervising load sequencing and pallet placement in trailers; verifying actual loads against manifests; coordinating temperature-controlled staging for refrigerated and frozen shipments; ensuring maximum ambient exposure limits are not exceeded (per SOP-07); obtaining driver signatures on the BOL; retaining the DC copy of the BOL; and reporting any load discrepancies to the Order Fulfillment Coordinator.
WMS Administrator	Maintains and operates the DeCA Warehouse Management System. Responsibilities include: configuring and releasing wave plans; generating and transmitting pick lists to picker RF devices; processing inventory adjustments resulting from short picks, cycle counts, or discrepancy reports; performing post-shipment WMS reconciliation; maintaining WMS system integrity and user access controls; and providing fulfillment data to the Order Fulfillment Coordinator for KPI reporting.
Transportation Coordinator	Responsible for all carrier-facing activities associated with outbound shipments. Responsibilities include: booking carrier capacity in the DeCA TMS per SOP-04 rate table; generating shipping manifests and transmitting

Role / Position	Responsibilities
	electronically to carriers within 2 hours of load completion; issuing Bills of Lading; monitoring carrier pickup compliance; tracking shipments post-tender; and coordinating with the Order Fulfillment Coordinator to resolve carrier-related issues (e.g., missed pickups, late arrivals, capacity shortfalls).
Carrier Representative	Acts as the authorized representative of the contracted transportation carrier (e.g., USMC Logistics, Army & Air Force Exchange, FedEx Ground). Responsibilities include: arriving at the DeCA DC at the scheduled appointment time; presenting valid carrier identification and pickup authorization; reviewing the shipment manifest and BOL with the Dock Supervisor; signing the BOL acknowledging receipt and condition of goods; and ensuring the trailer is sealed and secured prior to departure. Carriers are subject to performance monitoring per SOP-04.

6. Order Priority Levels

The DeCA Order Management System (OMS) classifies all inbound orders into one of three priority levels. Priority designation determines pick sequence, packing urgency, carrier booking lead time, and dock scheduling. All personnel must recognize and respond to priority designations appropriately. The Order Fulfillment Coordinator has authority to escalate or de-escalate order priority based on mission requirements and operational conditions.

Priority Level	OMS Code	Pick / Ship Timing	Authorized Use Cases	Special Handling Requirements
PRIORITY	PRI	Same-day pick; next-business-day shipment (carrier cutoff: 14:00 local DC time)	Military readiness resupply; emergency commissary restocking; operational support for active deployments; unit-level force feeding requirements	Immediately queue to top of wave sequence; assign experienced pickers (e.g., PKR-07, PKR-12) preferentially; Dock Supervisor notified at wave release; Order Fulfillment Coordinator monitors in real time. Carrier: USMC Logistics or Army & Air Force Exchange preferred.
STANDARD	STD	Next-business-day pick; 2-business-day shipment from order receipt	Routine commissary replenishment orders; installation store restocking; authorized individual customer orders not flagged as military readiness requirements	Included in standard wave planning cycle (see Section 7.3). Carrier selection per SOP-04 rate table. Pack stations PS-1, PS-2, and PS-3 all eligible.
BULK SCHEDULED	BSK	Pre-planned pick and ship schedule; typically weekly frequency per	Large-volume institutional commissary orders; recurring weekly or bi-	Wave planned in advance (minimum 48-hour lead time). Carrier pre-booked

Priority Level	OMS Code	Pick / Ship Timing	Authorized Use Cases	Special Handling Requirements
		agreed delivery calendar	weekly replenishment contracts; pre-positioned inventory for anticipated demand events (e.g., holidays, military exercises)	per Transportation Management Plan Rev. 2026. Dock scheduling coordinated directly with Dock Supervisor 24 hours prior to ship date. FedEx Ground or dedicated fleet preferred for volume movements.

IMPORTANT — PRIORITY ORDER ESCALATION

Any order with OMS Code "PRI" received after 12:00 (noon) local DC time must be immediately escalated to the Order Fulfillment Coordinator for determination of same-day feasibility. If same-day pick cannot be guaranteed, the Order Fulfillment Coordinator must notify the originating commissary or unit and document the delay with an approved reason code in the OMS within 30 minutes of determination.

7. Order Receipt and Release Procedure

The order receipt and release process encompasses all activities from initial order intake through the electronic transmission of pick tasks to picker RF devices. This process must be executed in strict accordance with the steps below to ensure

accurate inventory allocation, appropriate wave sequencing, and timely pick-task generation.

7.1 Order Receipt via DeCA Order Management System (OMS)

All customer orders must be received exclusively through the DeCA Order Management System (OMS). Paper-based, telephone, fax, or email orders are not authorized and shall not be processed under any circumstances. Orders transmitted via unauthorized channels must be rejected and the originating customer notified to resubmit through the OMS. All electronic orders are time-stamped upon receipt in the OMS, establishing the official order date and time for priority determination and SLA tracking purposes.

7.2 WMS Inventory Validation

Upon receipt of an order in the OMS, the system automatically interfaces with the DeCA Warehouse Management System (WMS) to validate available inventory against each line item on the order. The WMS performs the following validation checks:

- Confirms on-hand quantity at all eligible pick locations meets or exceeds the ordered quantity for each SKU.
- Verifies that available inventory is not reserved or allocated to a prior wave or higher-priority order.
- Identifies any SKUs with zero available inventory or insufficient quantity and flags these as potential short-pick lines.
- Checks lot/date codes to confirm available product meets FIFO requirements and has sufficient shelf life remaining per DeCA product freshness standards.

If all order lines are fully allocatable, the order status is updated to "READY FOR WAVE" in the OMS. If one or more lines cannot be fully allocated, the order is flagged as "PARTIAL ALLOCATION" and routed to the Order Fulfillment Coordinator for review before wave inclusion. The OMS will not auto-release a partial allocation order without coordinator approval.

7.3 Wave Planning

Wave planning is performed by the WMS Administrator in coordination with the Order Fulfillment Coordinator and Transportation Coordinator. Waves are built to optimize picking efficiency and ensure all orders meet their scheduled ship dates.

Wave planning criteria include:

- **Zone grouping:** Orders are grouped to consolidate picking activity within common warehouse zones (e.g., Zone A – Dry Grocery, Zone B – Frozen, Zone C – Produce, Zone D – General Merchandise), minimizing picker travel distance.
- **Carrier and ship date alignment:** Orders assigned to the same carrier and ship date are grouped into a common wave to facilitate coordinated trailer loading.
- **Priority sequencing:** PRIORITY (PRI) orders are assigned to the first wave of the day or the next available wave regardless of grouping optimization.
- **Picker capacity:** Wave size is calibrated to available picker headcount and equipment (RF scanners, pallet jacks, carts) to prevent task queue overload.

Completed wave plans are reviewed and approved by the Order Fulfillment Coordinator before release. Wave plans are retained in the WMS for a minimum of 90 days for audit purposes.

7.4 Pick List Generation and Release

Upon wave approval, the WMS automatically generates individual pick lists for each picker assigned to the wave. Pick tasks are transmitted electronically to assigned picker RF scanner devices. Each pick task includes: the picker ID (e.g., PKR-07, PKR-12, PKR-15), the pick location address (aisle, bay, level), the SKU/product barcode, the required quantity, the lot/date code to pick (FIFO-directed), and the designated pack station (PS-1, PS-2, or PS-3) for delivery. Pickers acknowledge task receipt on their RF scanner before proceeding to the first pick location.

8. Picking Procedure

The picking procedure governs all physical retrieval of product from DC storage locations in fulfillment of released wave pick tasks. All pickers must be RF scanner certified (see Section 15) prior to performing any picking tasks. Pickers must follow the steps below in sequence for each pick task assigned by the WMS.

EQUIPMENT REQUIRED

RF scanner (fully charged), pallet jack or picker cart (as appropriate for order type), personal protective equipment (PPE) per DC safety policy, and DC-issued picker ID badge. Pickers must not begin tasks without a functional RF scanner. Report device malfunctions to the WMS Administrator immediately.

8.1 Task Receipt on RF Scanner

The picker logs into the DeCA WMS via their assigned RF scanner using their unique Picker ID (e.g., PKR-07, PKR-12, PKR-15) and PIN. Upon login, the WMS displays the first pending pick task from the assigned wave, including the destination pick location, SKU, product description, required quantity, and target pack station. The picker acknowledges the task by selecting "ACCEPT" on the RF scanner screen before proceeding. If the picker is unable to accept a task (equipment issue, safety concern, physical inability to access location), they must notify the Order Fulfillment Coordinator via the RF scanner messaging function or directly.

8.2 Navigate to Pick Location (Directed Pick)

The WMS directs the picker to the optimized pick location using the DC location address displayed on the RF scanner (e.g., Zone C / Aisle 04 / Bay 12 / Level 2). Pickers must follow the directed path and are prohibited from picking from alternate locations unless the WMS has generated a directed location override due to a stock-out or system-flagged discrepancy. Unauthorized substitution of product from non-directed locations constitutes a picking error and must be reported immediately.

8.3 Scan Location Barcode to Confirm

Upon arriving at the directed pick location, the picker must scan the location barcode affixed to the storage rack or bin. The WMS validates the scanned location against the directed location for the current task. If the location scan does not match, the RF scanner will display an error message and audible alert, and the picker must not proceed with the pick until the correct location is confirmed or a location override is issued by the WMS Administrator. This step is mandatory and may not be bypassed.

8.4 Scan Product UPC/Barcode

After successful location confirmation, the picker scans the UPC or product barcode on the item to be picked. The WMS validates the scanned barcode against the SKU required for the current pick task. If the barcode does not match the expected SKU, the RF scanner displays an error and the picker must not pick the item. Pickers must never manually enter product information in lieu of scanning. If a product barcode is damaged or unscannable, the picker must notify the WMS Administrator and await a system resolution before proceeding.

8.5 Pick Quantity Verification and FIFO Enforcement

After successful product scan confirmation, the picker inputs the quantity picked on the RF scanner. The WMS compares the entered quantity against the required quantity on the pick task. FIFO is strictly enforced: the WMS directs pickers to the location and lot/date code representing the earliest received inventory for each SKU. Pickers must not select newer lot codes when older lot codes are available at the directed location, even if the newer product is physically more accessible. FIFO compliance is verified by the WMS through lot-code scanning at pick locations with lot-tracking enabled.

8.6 Short Pick Documentation

A short pick occurs when the available quantity at the directed location is less than the quantity required by the pick task. When a short pick is encountered, the picker must:

1. Enter the actual quantity picked (which may be zero if the location is empty).

2. Select the applicable short-pick reason code from the RF scanner menu (e.g., RSN-01: Location Empty; RSN-02: Product Damaged/Unsaleable; RSN-03: Lot Code Mismatch; RSN-04: Product Not Found at Location).
3. Confirm the short-pick entry on the RF scanner. The WMS will automatically flag the affected order line for review and notify the Order Fulfillment Coordinator.
4. Proceed with remaining pick tasks. Do not attempt to source the short-pick item from an alternate location without explicit WMS direction or coordinator authorization.

The Order Fulfillment Coordinator will review all flagged short picks and determine the appropriate resolution (e.g., inventory search, substitute SKU authorization if applicable, partial shipment authorization, or back-order placement in the OMS).

8.7 Place Picked Items on Designated Pallet or Cart

Upon completing each confirmed pick, the picker places the item(s) on the designated pallet or picker cart for the assigned wave. Pallets and carts are labeled with the wave ID and destination pack station (PS-1, PS-2, or PS-3). Pickers must not commingle items from different waves or different pack station assignments on the same pallet or cart. Upon completion of all tasks in the wave, the picker transports the loaded pallet or cart to the designated pack station and checks in with the Packer, confirming the wave ID and order count.

WARNING — TEMPERATURE-SENSITIVE PRODUCT HANDLING

Refrigerated (chilled) and frozen product must be moved from cold storage to the pack station without delay. Maximum allowable ambient exposure time prior to packing is 10 minutes for refrigerated items and 5 minutes for frozen items, consistent with SOP-07. Pickers must not stage temperature-sensitive items in ambient areas while completing non-refrigerated picks.

9. Packing Procedure

The packing procedure governs all activities at pack stations PS-1, PS-2, and PS-3, from the receipt of picked items from the picker through the preparation of sealed, labeled cartons ready for staging. Packers are responsible for the final accuracy verification of all outbound shipments and bear primary accountability for the Order Accuracy Rate KPI at the carton level.

9.1 Receipt of Picked Items at Pack Station

The Packer at the assigned pack station (PS-1, PS-2, or PS-3) receives the picker's pallet or cart delivery and confirms the wave ID and order list with the picker before the picker departs. The Packer logs into the WMS pack-station interface using their employee ID and selects the incoming wave/order to initiate the packing verification process. All items must be physically present on the pallet or cart before packing begins; the Packer must not initiate packing based on expected quantities alone.

9.2 Item Scan Verification Against Order

For each item received at the pack station, the Packer scans the product barcode using the pack-station scanner. The WMS pack-station interface displays the expected SKU, description, and quantity for the order and confirms each scan in real time. The Packer must:

- Scan every individual unit — no bulk overrides or quantity-keying in lieu of scanning.
- Confirm that the scanned SKU matches the order requirement displayed by the WMS.
- Flag any over-pick (quantity received exceeds order quantity) or mis-pick (wrong SKU received) to the Order Fulfillment Coordinator immediately and do not pack flagged items until the discrepancy is resolved.
- Record all discrepancies in the WMS packing log before proceeding.

9.3 Dimensional Weight Application

The Packer selects the appropriate carton size to minimize void space while safely protecting the product. Dimensional weight (DIM weight) is calculated by the pack-station WMS terminal for each carton using the formula: **(Length × Width × Height) ÷ 139** (standard DIM factor for ground carriers). If the DIM weight exceeds the actual weight, DIM weight is used for carrier billing purposes. Carton selection must balance product protection against unnecessary carton size up-grades that increase DIM weight charges. The WMS records actual and DIM weight for each sealed carton and transmits this data to the TMS for manifest generation.

9.4 Cold and Frozen Item Packing

Cold and frozen items require special packing procedures consistent with DeCA SOP-07 (Cold Chain and Temperature-Sensitive Product Handling):

- **Refrigerated items (33°F - 41°F):** Pack in insulated cartons with sufficient refrigerant gel packs to maintain product temperature for the carrier transit time plus a 4-hour buffer. Use gel packs pre-conditioned to the appropriate temperature per SOP-07 specifications.
- **Frozen items (0°F or below):** Pack in insulated cartons with dry ice at the quantity specified in SOP-07 based on carton size and transit time. Dry ice handling must comply with applicable DOT and OSHA regulations, including use of insulated gloves and ventilated work areas. Personnel handling dry ice must be trained per Section 15 of this SOP.
- All temperature-sensitive cartons must be labeled with the applicable temperature-range label (e.g., "KEEP REFRIGERATED 33°F-41°F" or "KEEP FROZEN — DRY ICE — DO NOT TOUCH") in addition to the standard shipping label.

9.5 Packing Slip Insertion

A WMS-generated packing slip must be inserted into each carton before sealing. The packing slip includes: the order number (e.g., ORD-2026-88001), customer/commissary name and address, a complete itemized list of contents with SKU, description, and quantity, the picker ID, pack station ID, and pack date/time.

The packing slip serves as the customer's receipt and is required for delivery verification and dispute resolution. If a packing slip cannot be printed due to system or equipment failure, the Order Fulfillment Coordinator must be notified and a manual packing slip completed before carton sealing.

9.6 Carton Sealing and Labeling

Upon completion of item verification and packing slip insertion, the Packer seals the carton with pressure-sensitive tape applied per DC packing standards (minimum 3-strip H-seal method). The WMS pack-station interface then prints the carrier shipping label, which includes all required data elements:

- Carrier name and logo (e.g., FedEx Ground, USMC Logistics, Army & Air Force Exchange)
- Order ID (e.g., ORD-2026-88005)
- Carrier tracking number / PRO number
- Ship-from address (DeCA DC name, address, dock door)
- Ship-to address (commissary or installation store name and address)
- Carton number (e.g., 1 of 3)
- Dimensional weight and actual weight
- Service level (Priority, Standard, or Bulk Scheduled)

The shipping label is affixed to the largest face of the carton in a clear, accessible location free of straps, tape, or obstructions. Cartons with damaged, illegible, or improperly placed labels must be relabeled before staging.

10. Staging and Loading

Staging and loading encompasses all activities between the completion of packing and the formal handoff of goods to the carrier at the dock door. The Dock Supervisor has primary authority for all staging and loading activities. Carrier

drivers may observe but may not direct or participate in the loading process without explicit authorization from the Dock Supervisor.

10.1 Pallet Building per Carrier Trailer Assignments

Sealed cartons from pack stations PS-1, PS-2, and PS-3 are transported to the staging area and palletized per carrier and trailer door assignments established by the Transportation Coordinator in the TMS. Pallets must be built in accordance with the following standards:

- Maximum pallet height: 60 inches (including pallet).
- Maximum pallet weight: 2,500 lbs per pallet.
- All cartons must be stretch-wrapped to the pallet with a minimum of 3 wrap layers before staging in the dock area.
- Carrier-specific pallet labels (generated by the TMS) must be affixed to two sides of each pallet.
- Cartons must not overhang pallet edges by more than 1 inch on any side.

10.2 Refrigerated Item Staging

Pallets containing refrigerated or frozen cartons must be staged in the designated temperature-controlled cooler or freezer staging area adjacent to the dock doors until the carrier trailer is confirmed temperature-conditioned and the dock door is ready for loading. The maximum allowable ambient exposure time from cooler/freezer staging exit to trailer load completion is **10 minutes** for refrigerated items and **5 minutes** for frozen items, consistent with SOP-07. The Dock Supervisor is responsible for monitoring and enforcing these limits. Any exceedance must be documented and reported to the Order Fulfillment Coordinator and Quality Assurance.

10.3 Load Sequence

Trailers must be loaded in the following sequence to maximize freight protection, load stability, and unloading efficiency at the destination commissary:

5. **First loaded (deepest in trailer):** Heavy, dense, stable items — canned goods, beverages, bulk dry goods. These items form the structural base of the load and are unloaded last at delivery.
6. **Mid-load:** Standard ambient-temperature grocery items — boxed goods, personal care products, general merchandise.
7. **Last loaded (closest to dock door):** Temperature-sensitive refrigerated and frozen items — placed last to minimize transit time at ambient temperature and allow quickest transfer to receiving coolers at destination. Frozen items are positioned closest to the trailer refrigeration unit.

The Dock Supervisor must verify that all loaded cartons are secured against load shift using load bars, straps, or airbags as appropriate for trailer type. Unsecured loads are a safety hazard and a compliance violation.

10.4 Driver and Dock Supervisor Load Verification

Prior to trailer seal, the authorized carrier driver and Dock Supervisor jointly verify the loaded trailer against the shipment manifest. Verification includes:

- Confirming total pallet count matches the manifest.
- Confirming carrier labels and tracking numbers on staged cartons are legible and undamaged.
- Confirming no freight belonging to other carriers or orders is present in the trailer.
- Visually inspecting the trailer interior for obvious load damage, shifted freight, or improper stacking.

Any discrepancy noted during joint verification must be resolved before the trailer is sealed. The Dock Supervisor has authority to refuse trailer seal until all discrepancies are corrected.

10.5 Bill of Lading Execution and Retention

Upon successful load verification, the Transportation Coordinator generates the Bill of Lading (BOL) from the DeCA TMS. The BOL must be signed by the authorized carrier driver, acknowledging receipt and acceptance of the shipment in apparent

good order and condition. The Dock Supervisor countersigns the BOL on behalf of DeCA. Distribution of the BOL is as follows:

- **Original:** Carrier driver (travels with the shipment).
- **DC Copy:** Retained by the Dock Supervisor in the DC BOL file for a minimum of 3 years per DeCA records retention policy.
- **Electronic Copy:** Uploaded to the DeCA TMS by the Transportation Coordinator within 1 hour of trailer departure.

11. Carrier Booking and Manifesting

All carrier booking and manifest activities must be executed exclusively through the DeCA Transportation Management System (TMS). No direct or off-system carrier bookings are authorized. The Transportation Coordinator is the sole authorized user for TMS carrier booking functions, though the Order Fulfillment Coordinator may initiate a booking request through the TMS workflow for urgent PRIORITY orders.

11.1 Carrier Selection

Carrier selection must comply with the carrier rate table and routing guide defined in DeCA SOP-04 (Transportation Carrier Management). Carrier selection criteria include destination region, order priority level, weight and cube, temperature requirements, and carrier performance history. The following authorized carriers are currently integrated in the DeCA TMS:

- **USMC Logistics:** Primary carrier for shipments to Marine Corps installations. Preferred for PRIORITY order movements.
- **Army & Air Force Exchange (AAFES):** Primary carrier for shipments to Army and Air Force installation commissaries. Authorized for PRIORITY and STANDARD orders.

- **FedEx Ground:** Secondary carrier for STANDARD and BULK SCHEDULED shipments; primary carrier for commercial-zone deliveries and overflow volume from primary carriers.

Carrier substitution outside the SOP-04 rate table is not authorized without written approval from the Director, Logistics & Distribution.

11.2 Carrier Booking in the DeCA TMS

The Transportation Coordinator initiates carrier bookings in the DeCA TMS as follows:

8. Log into the DeCA TMS with authorized credentials.
9. Select "New Booking" and link the booking to the applicable wave/order set using the wave ID from the WMS.
10. Input shipment details: total weight, total cube, pallet count, temperature requirements, and requested pickup date/time.
11. Select the carrier per the SOP-04 rate table routing guide.
12. Confirm carrier appointment slot — the TMS interfaces directly with carrier scheduling systems for USMC Logistics and AAFES; FedEx Ground bookings are submitted via the FedEx TMS API integration.
13. Record the carrier confirmation/booking number in the TMS and communicate to the Dock Supervisor for trailer scheduling.

11.3 Manifest Generation and Transmission

Upon completion of trailer loading and BOL execution (Section 10.5), the Transportation Coordinator generates the outbound shipment manifest in the DeCA TMS. The manifest includes all carton-level detail: order IDs, SKUs, quantities, weights, dimensions, tracking numbers, and pallet assignments. The completed manifest must be electronically transmitted to the carrier's designated receiving system **within 2 hours of load completion**. Late manifest transmission is tracked as a compliance metric. The manifest is also transmitted to the destination commissary's receiving system via OMS-TMS integration to enable advance shipment notification (ASN) processing.

COMPLIANCE NOTE

Manifest transmission compliance (within 2-hour window) is tracked monthly by the Supply Chain Operations Division and reported to the Director, Logistics & Distribution as part of the DeCA Fulfillment Operations Dashboard. Consistent non-compliance may result in operational review and corrective action planning.

12. Order Accuracy Verification

Order accuracy verification is a critical post-shipment control activity designed to confirm that all outbound shipments were fulfilled correctly and to identify and remediate any errors in a timely manner. The following verification activities are mandatory for all outbound shipments.

12.1 Post-Shipment WMS Reconciliation

Within 1 hour of trailer departure, the WMS Administrator performs a post-shipment reconciliation in the WMS. This process compares the planned order quantities (per the original pick list and wave plan) against the actual quantities scanned at the pack station and recorded on the manifest. Any discrepancy between planned and actual quantities is flagged as a reconciliation exception and routed to the Order Fulfillment Coordinator for classification and disposition.

12.2 Automated OMS Comparison

The DeCA OMS performs an automated comparison of the transmitted manifest against the original order records for each shipment, typically within 30 minutes of manifest receipt. The OMS compares: order line quantities ordered vs. quantities shipped; SKUs ordered vs. SKUs shipped; and ship-to addresses. Orders where manifest data matches order records are automatically updated to "SHIPPED — COMPLETE" status in the OMS. Orders with discrepancies are flagged as "SHIPPED — PARTIAL" or "SHIPPED — EXCEPTION" and require manual coordinator review.

12.3 Partial Shipment Notification

When a partial shipment is identified (one or more order lines shipped at less than the ordered quantity), the Order Fulfillment Coordinator must notify the affected commissary or customer through the OMS messaging function **within 4 hours of shipment departure**. The notification must include: the order number, the specific line(s) affected, the quantity shipped vs. quantity ordered, the reason code (if known), and the estimated availability date for back-ordered items. Partial shipments must also be reported to the Supply Chain Operations Division for inclusion in monthly KPI reporting.

12.4 Order Accuracy Reporting

The WMS Administrator compiles order accuracy data on a daily basis and submits a summary to the Order Fulfillment Coordinator by 08:00 each morning covering the previous business day's shipments. Weekly summaries are compiled by the Order Fulfillment Coordinator and submitted to the Supply Chain Operations Division. Monthly KPI reports are prepared by the Supply Chain Operations Division and submitted to the Director, Logistics & Distribution by the 5th business day of the following month.

13. Example Order Data

The following table presents ten representative order records processed through the DeCA OMS under this SOP. These synthetic examples illustrate the range of order types, priority levels, pack station assignments, picker assignments, carrier routing, and shipment statuses encountered in daily fulfillment operations. All order IDs, picker IDs, tracking numbers, and SKUs are synthetic examples for procedural illustration only.

Order ID	Priority	SKU	Description	Qty (Cases)	Picker ID	Pack Station	Carrier	Tracking Number	Status
ORD-2026-88001	PRI	SKU-04421	Canned Vegetables Assorted, 24-ct Case	40	PKR-07	PS-1	USMC Logistics	USMC-2026-110441	SHIPPED — COMPLETE
ORD-2026-88002	PRI	SKU-09873	Bottled Water, 40-ct Flat, 16.9 oz	60	PKR-12	PS-2	USMC Logistics	USMC-2026-110442	SHIPPED — COMPLETE
ORD-2026-88003	STD	SKU-11204	Frozen Entrees Assorted, 12-ct Case	25	PKR-15	PS-3	Army & Air Force Exchange	AAFES-2026-330871	SHIPPED — COMPLETE
ORD-2026-88004	STD	SKU-07652	Breakfast Cereal Variety Pack, 6-ct Case	18	PKR-07	PS-1	FedEx Ground	FXG-2026-774512	SHIPPED — COMPLETE
ORD-2026-88005	STD	SKU-03318	Paper Towels, 8-roll Mega Pack, 6-ct Case	30	PKR-12	PS-2	FedEx Ground	FXG-2026-774513	SHIPPED — COMPLETE
ORD-2026-88006	BSK	SKU-14490	Laundry Detergent Liquid, 100	80	PKR-15	PS-3	FedEx Ground	FXG-2026-774514	SHIPPED — COMPLETE

Order ID	Priority	SKU	Description	Qty (Cases)	Picker ID	Pack Station	Carrier	Tracking Number	Status
			oz, 4-ct Case						
ORD-2026-88007	STD	SKU-08815	Refrigerated Cheese Variety, 12-ct Case	15	PKR-07	PS-1	Army & Air Force Exchange	AAFES-2026-330872	SHIPPED — PARTIAL (13/15 cases; RSN-01: Location Short)
ORD-2026-88008	BSK	SKU-21037	Cooking Oil Vegetable, 1-gal, 6-ct Case	50	PKR-12	PS-2	FedEx Ground	FXG-2026-774515	SHIPPED — COMPLETE
ORD-2026-88009	PRI	SKU-05509	MRE Case, 12-meal Case, DoD Spec	100	PKR-15	PS-3	USMC Logistics	USMC-2026-110443	SHIPPED — COMPLETE
ORD-2026-88010	STD	SKU-16672	Frozen Seafood Assorted, 10 lb Case	20	PKR-07	PS-1	Army & Air Force Exchange	AAFES-2026-330873	IN PROCESS — PACKING (PS-1)

Note: All order IDs, SKUs, tracking numbers, picker IDs, and statuses in the above table are synthetic examples generated for procedural illustration purposes only and do not represent actual DeCA shipment records.

14. Key Performance Indicators (KPIs)

The following KPIs govern the measurement and evaluation of order fulfillment operational performance at all DeCA distribution centers. KPI targets represent minimum acceptable performance levels. The Supply Chain Operations Division is responsible for monitoring KPI performance on a daily, weekly, and monthly basis and reporting results to the Director, Logistics & Distribution. Sustained performance below target thresholds will trigger a formal Corrective Action Plan (CAP) process.

KPI Name	Target	Reporting Frequency	Measurement Method	Owner / Accountable Role
Order Fill Rate	≥99%	Daily / Monthly	Total order lines shipped complete ÷ Total order lines received × 100. Sourced from OMS post-shipment reconciliation report.	Order Fulfillment Coordinator; reported by WMS Administrator
Order Accuracy Rate	≥99.5%	Daily / Monthly	Orders shipped without item, quantity, or address error ÷ Total orders shipped × 100. Error data sourced from OMS exception log and customer discrepancy reports.	Order Fulfillment Coordinator; verified by Supply Chain Operations Division
On-Time Shipment Rate	≥98%	Daily / Monthly	Shipments tendered to carrier on or before scheduled ship	Transportation Coordinator; reported by WMS Administrator

KPI Name	Target	Reporting Frequency	Measurement Method	Owner / Accountable Role
			date/time ÷ Total shipments × 100. Sourced from TMS carrier booking and departure log.	
Pick Productivity	≥120 cases/hour	Daily / Weekly	Total cases picked per shift ÷ Total picker hours worked per shift. Sourced from WMS pick task completion log by picker ID (e.g., PKR-07, PKR-12, PKR-15). Excludes non-pick activities (breaks, meetings, training).	Order Fulfillment Coordinator; monitored per individual Picker ID
Partial Shipment Rate	≤1%	Daily / Monthly	Orders shipped with one or more lines at less than ordered quantity ÷ Total orders shipped × 100. Sourced from OMS partial shipment notification log and WMS reconciliation exceptions.	Order Fulfillment Coordinator; Supply Chain Operations Division

PERFORMANCE THRESHOLD — CORRECTIVE ACTION TRIGGER

Any KPI that falls below its target threshold for two consecutive reporting periods (daily or monthly, as applicable) will trigger a mandatory review by the Supply Chain Operations Division. A formal Corrective Action Plan (CAP) must be submitted to the Director, Logistics & Distribution within 5 business days of the threshold breach determination. CAP progress is reviewed at monthly Supply Chain Operations Review meetings.

15. Training Requirements

All personnel assigned to roles defined in Section 5 of this SOP must complete and maintain current certification in the applicable training modules listed below. Training records are maintained by the DeCA Human Resources Division and are subject to audit by the Supply Chain Operations Division. No personnel may perform fulfillment tasks under this SOP until all required initial certifications are obtained and documented.

Training Module	Applicable Roles	Initial Certification	Recertification	Description
RF Scanner Certification	Picker, Packer, Dock Supervisor	Prior to first assignment; practical exam required	Every 2 years or upon WMS platform upgrade	Covers RF scanner device operation, WMS pick/pack task navigation, barcode scanning techniques, error message response procedures, and device maintenance. Includes a

Training Module	Applicable Roles	Initial Certification	Recertification	Description
				supervised practical assessment of minimum 50 scan accuracy rate of $\geq 99.5\%$.
WMS and OMS Operations Training	WMS Administrator, Order Fulfillment Coordinator, Transportation Coordinator	Prior to system access; computer-based training (CBT) + instructor-led session	Annually; additionally upon major system updates	Covers DeCA WMS configuration, wave planning, pick task management, inventory adjustment procedures, post-shipment reconciliation, OMS order management, TMS carrier booking, and manifest generation. Access to production systems is granted only upon certification completion.
Cold Chain Handling Refresher	Picker, Packer, Dock Supervisor, Order Fulfillment Coordinator	Prior to handling refrigerated/frozen product; CBT module	Annually; additionally upon SOP-07 revision	Covers temperature requirements for refrigerated (33°F–41°F) and frozen (0°F and below) product categories, maximum ambient exposure time limits, dry ice handling procedures

Training Module	Applicable Roles	Initial Certification	Recertification	Description
				and DOT/OSHA compliance, refrigerant gel pack conditioning, temperature monitoring equipment use, and escalation procedures for temperature exceedances. Completion logged against individual employee records.
Annual Safety Training	All fulfillment operations personnel	Within 30 days of assignment to DC operations	Annually (calendar year)	Covers DC warehouse safety: forklift and pallet jack safe operation, slip/trip/fall hazard awareness, proper manual lifting techniques, PPE requirements by work area, emergency evacuation procedures, hazardous materials (HAZMAT) awareness, and incident reporting. Delivered by DC Safety Officer via instructor-led session with written knowledge

Training Module	Applicable Roles	Initial Certification	Recertification	Description
				assessment. A minimum passing score of 80% is required.
DeCA FOUO and Information Security Awareness	All personnel with access to OMS, WMS, or TMS	Prior to system access	Annually	Covers handling requirements for FOUO-designated materials and data, applicable provisions of DoD 5400.07-R, information system access control policies, and incident reporting for suspected unauthorized disclosure. Delivered via DeCA mandatory CBT module through the DeCA Learning Management System (LMS).

Training completion records must be maintained in the DeCA LMS and made available for inspection by the Supply Chain Operations Division, DeCA Inspector General (IG), or other authorized oversight entities upon request. Personnel whose certifications have lapsed must be removed from applicable fulfillment duties until recertification is completed and documented.

16. Revision History

The following table documents the revision history of this Standard Operating Procedure. All revisions are subject to review by the Supply Chain Operations Division and formal approval by the Director, Logistics & Distribution before becoming effective. Superseded versions of this SOP are archived by the DeCA Records Management Office and retained for a minimum of 7 years.

Version	Effective Date	Author / Revised By	Approved By	Summary of Changes
1.0	August 1, 2026	Supply Chain Operations Division	Director, Logistics & Distribution	Initial release. Establishes baseline order fulfillment procedures for all DeCA DC operations, including order receipt, wave planning, picking, packing, staging, loading, carrier booking, manifesting, accuracy verification, KPIs, and training requirements. Supersedes all prior informal or local DC-level fulfillment guidance.

Approval Signatures

The undersigned authorize the release and implementation of DeCA-SC-SOP-03, Revision 1.0, effective August 1, 2026.

Reviewed By: Supply
Chain Operations Division Date:

Approved By: Director,
Logistics & Distribution Date:

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